



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Libertas Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.libertasmo.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Libertas Christian Academy (Farmington, MO) presents a robust Classical-Christian program that aligns closely with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. The public materials consistently articulate a Christian foundation, a Trivium-centered curriculum (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), and explicit emphasis on the seven liberal arts, great books, and Western civilization. The school itself states a mission to partner with Christian parents in the education and spiritual development of their children, and it situates its program within a church-affiliated context (Parkland Chapel). These elements collectively signal a classical orientation, with a strong emphasis on formation of character, virtue, and assent to transcendent truths. The overall assessment across the six rubric categories is CLASSICAL, with only minor ambiguity in pedagogy granularity (some traditional/classical indicators are present, while explicit description of every classical pedagogy element (e.g., specific Socratic seminar practices) is less overt in the site copy).

Key evidence highlights include: - Explicit identification as a Christian and Classical school, with the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) defined as foundational and the School of Grammar (K-6), School of Logic (7-9), and School of Rhetoric (10-12) described on the site. - Clear articulation of the Classical curriculum emphasis, including the seven liberal arts and the great books of Western civilization. - The Word of God is presented as Truth, with explicit references to scripture and the school's theological grounding (Statement of Faith, Parkland Chapel affiliation).

- Mission and outcomes frame education as formation (virtue, wisdom) in a classical framework, and there is explicit language about partnership with Christian parents. - Evidence of liturgical/congregational framing (Discipleship, Word of God page, coat-of-arms motto Veritas Vos Liberabit) that reinforces metaphysical foundations.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

What would move the needle sections are not included here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Word of God is Truth is a central page, anchoring the school's metaphysical stance with explicit biblical language (John 14:6; John 16:13; 2 Corinthians 3:17). - The school is affiliated with Parkland Chapel and includes a Statement of Faith, underscoring theological grounding and liturgical/communal orientation. - The coat-of-arms motto Veritas Vos Liberabit (Truth shall make you free) highlights transcendental

aims and a clear metaphysical frame. - Discipleship and Vision/Mission materials emphasize a theologically informed education and spiritual development, tying virtue, truth, and sacred formation to daily practice.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty (transcendentals); theology; liturgy/worship; sacred scripture; catechesis; prayerful community; Logos; sacred/Christian worldview. The site repeatedly foregrounds truth as anchored in scripture and Christ, with explicit theology and liturgical/communal framing. Positive keyword indicators drawn from the Six Elements lexicon include truth, theology, liturgy, worship, sacred tradition, and sacred text. - Negative keywords present: minimal to none in public materials (no explicit secular, relativistic, or value-neutral framing observed in the site copy). The lexicon warns against secular or relativistic signals, which are not evident in these materials.

Why this rating - The public materials place explicit emphasis on Truth as knowable via Scripture, a theologically grounded education, and liturgical/community practices, all of which map to the Positive keywords listed for this category. The absence of secular/relativistic signals in the school's public materials supports a CLASSICAL rating here. The presence of Parkland Chapel affiliation and a Statement of Faith reinforces a grounded theological basis rather than a secular or neutral stance.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission states partnership with Christian parents in education and spiritual development, and commitment to a Classical approach with seven liberal arts and the great books of western civilization. This frames education as formation and access to universal truths rather than job-preparation alone. - Foundational texts emphasize formation of wisdom and virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable. The public materials consistently connect virtue, character formation, and lifelong learning with the classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, great conversation, perennial questions, and Christian formation. The lexicon's Positive Keywords for this category include formation, paideia, great conversation, and telos. The site uses language aligning with formation and virtue, and emphasizes truth/goodness/beauty. - Negative keywords present: none observed (no strong evidence of career-prep- or skills-first framing that would signal a non-classical orientation). The absence of a primary emphasis on workforce readiness aligns with Classical pedagogy expectations.

Why this rating - The school's stated purpose centers formation and classical formation with a transcendent curriculum, aligning with the Positive keyword set for this category. The explicit mention of liberal arts, Great Books, and a mission to form virtue and wisdom, rather than merely prepare for work, supports CLASSICAL here.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Academics page foregrounds the Classical model and the three Trivium arts (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), with a School of Grammar (K-6), School of Logic (7-9), and School of Rhetoric (10-12). This is the core structure of a classical curriculum. - The site explicitly notes seven liberal arts, the study of the Great Books, and the Great Conversation as part of Libertas' curriculum framework. - The "Classical Education" page presents the school as a Classical and Christian education, underscoring the Trivium and Quadrivium as foundational content streams. - The School of Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric pages enumerate the pathway through K-12 in a manner consistent with classical curriculum design.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric); Great Books; Great Conversation; Western civilization; primary sources; classical languages; history integrated across disciplines. These terms appear in multiple pages and reflect a classic curriculum framework (per the Six Elements lexicon). - Negative keywords present: None observed (no modernist, social-studies-as-history-only language or project-based-first framing detected in the cited curriculum content). The site remains anchored in traditional classical content.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly built around the classical trinity of grammar-logic-rhetoric, the seven liberal arts, and the great books, matching the Positive keywords and structure described in the classical lexicon. The presence of Great Books and a clearly delineated three-tier classical program strongly supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public materials emphasize a classical pedagogy (grammar-logic-rhetoric progression) and the Great Books approach, with a focus on formation and disciplined study. Content references to teachers guiding students through these stages align with classical pedagogy generally. - The site presents a general sense of nurturing memory and mastery via the Trivium, though explicit, detailed descriptions of Socratic seminars, daily scholé (restful learning), or direct quotes about upper-school seminars/debates are not consistently spelled out in the visible site text. The Great Books/Trivium framing is present, but explicit, repeated references to Socratic seminars, chanting, or formal recitation protocols (aside from general "tools of learning" language) are not consistently documented in the accessible pages. - The Pedagogy lexicon (from the Six Elements) includes Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/recitation, and formation through imitation as hallmark practices. The Libertas materials do not consistently enumerate these four pedagogical techniques in explicit, repeated form in the accessible copies, though the overall tradition is clearly compatible with those methods.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (explicit mentions are partial): grammar, logic, rhetoric (core Trivium); great books; memorization/recitation (not consistently explicit in site text); use of memory devices or chant-like memory work (not consistently explicit in the accessible text). The site strongly mentions Trivium and Great Books but does not repeatedly confirm explicit Socratic seminars or scholé wording in the public copy. Therefore some classical pedagogy indicators are present, but not exhaustively documented on the pages we have, yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL reading. Positive keyword indicators (grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; Trivium; formation) appear; explicit "Socratic discussion" and "scholé" terms are not consistently present in the visible content. - Negative keywords present: minimal to none in the accessible site text (no modern "project-based-first" or secular, non-traditional pedagogy language clearly visible in the cited pages). The absence of explicit non-classical pedagogy language supports CLASSICAL, but the lack of detailed procedural pedagogy language pushes to SOMEWHAT rather than CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Libertas' curricular framing is strongly classical (Trivium, Great Books). However, explicit public documentation of the pedagogical methods (e.g., detailed Socratic seminars, scholé practice, chant/mnemonic recitation protocols) is not consistently foregrounded in the accessible materials. This combination justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy at present, given the robust classical structure but less overt, consistently documented pedagogy language.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site references are dominated by institutional and leadership materials (Head of School, admissions, etc.), and there is emphasis on mentors, partnerships with families, and the "living curriculum" notion typical of classical settings. The Admissions Overview shows a school culture built around collaborative parent-teacher-student involvement, implying a teacher-centered and virtue-formation-based faculty culture. - The materials describe teachers and staff in the context of a Christian, classical education program, with references to discipleship and formation, which align with the classical teacher as mentor and model of virtue. While explicit "portrait of a teacher" or "faculty as living curriculum" phrases are not verbatim on every page, the textual emphasis on virtue, character formation, and classical pedagogy is consistent with a CLASSICAL faculty framing.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers/mentors; virtue formation; living curriculum; teacher as guide; classical pedagogy; mentorship; character formation. The classical lexicon lists these as favorable faculty indicators. The site's emphasis on discipleship, formation, and classical structure supports these signals. - Negative keywords present: none observed in the accessible text (no

hints of a detached or exclusively corporate/credentialed faculty model; rather, a relational, mentor-oriented framing is suggested).

Why this rating - The school's classical framework and formation emphasis, together with references to leadership, discipleship, and partnership with families, align with a CLASSICAL faculty profile. The absence of explicit counter-signals further supports CLASSICAL here.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission explicitly states partnership with Christian parents in education and spiritual development, indicating a shared mission and parental involvement as co-educators. The "Admissions" materials outline parent/stakeholder involvement and learning alongside their children. - The site communicates a strong culture of parental engagement (parents learn alongside children; many pages reference parent participation in admissions, enrollment, and mentorship). There are multiple pages highlighting parental partnership and community involvement. - The school is positioned on church property and connected to Parkland Chapel, which situates the school within a community ecosystem that includes families and church members in a shared mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teaching with families; parental formation; family involvement; open campus/visits; community of learners; parental leadership; living tradition in the family. The classical lexicon includes "Partnership with Families," "parent formation," and "home-centered learning" as critical pieces of the community element. - Negative keywords present: none evident (the site does not frame parents as customers or marginalize family involvement).

Why this rating - The materials consistently foreground parental partnership and family involvement as central to the classical model, aligning with the Element 6 Positive keyword indicators and the lexicon. The school's integration with a local church community further reinforces the community dimension. This supports CLASSICAL for Parents & Community.

Overall Assessment

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL

- The Libertas Christian Academy materials demonstrate a coherent Classical-Christian identity across Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents/Community.
- Pedagogy, while clearly rooted in classical aims (Trivium, Great Books, formation), is not as exhaustively described in public copy for every traditional pedagogical practice (e.g., explicit long-form Socratic seminars or scholé protocols). This yields a rating of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy, but does not override the strong overall Classical alignment in the other five categories.
- Taken together, the school's public-facing materials align with CLASSICAL education as defined by the Six Essential Elements.

What would move the needle (only relevant if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - If Pedagogy were documented with explicit, recurring practices such as regular Socratic seminars, formal scholé days, memorization/recitation protocols, and explicit formation-through-imitation practices in the upper grades, the Pedagogy rating would shift to CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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